Kristopher Noah Velasco

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CV last updated: October 13, 2026

Department of Sociology
Princeton University
185 Wallace Hall
Princeton, NJ 08544

Employment

2021- Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

- Robert K. Root University Preceptorship, 2025-2028
- Faculty Associate, Program in Gender and Sexuality Studies
- Faculty Associate, Office of Population Research

Education

2021 PhD in Sociology, University of Texas at Austin

- Dissertation: *Caught in a Web: How Rival Transnational Networks (Un)Do LGBT+ Rights*
- 2020 Kenneth Sherrill Prize, Best Dissertation Proposal in LGBT Politics, American Political Science Association
- Committee: Pamela Paxton (Chair), Javier Auyero, Debra Umberson, David John Frank (University of California, Irvine), Phillip Ayoub (University College London)

2017 MA in Sociology, University of Texas at Austin

2011 BA in Sociology and Political Science with Honors, University of Kansas

Research Interests

Political Sociology	Organizations	Gender & Sexuality
Culture	Global & Transnational Sociology	Migration

Books

On-Going **Velasco, Kristopher**. *God's Money: U.S. Civil Society, LGBTQ+ Rights, and the Unraveling of Global Democracy.* Under Contract. Princeton University Press.

Journal Articles

*Indicates (Under)Graduate Student Co-Author

Forthcoming Hoffmann, Nathan I. and **Kristopher Velasco**. "The Geography of Immigrants in Same-Sex Couples in the United States." *Journal of Ethnic & Migration Studies.* Preprint.

Forthcoming Messamore, Andrew, Pamela Paxton, and **Kristopher Velasco**. "The Heart vs. the Head: How Nonprofit Use of Emotion and Cognition Attracts Donors and Volunteers." *Nonprofit*

and Voluntary Sector Quarterly.

2025 Hoffmann, Nathan I. and **Kristopher Velasco**."Sexuality, Cultural Similarity, and Immigrant Deservingness: Evidence from a Conjoint Survey Experiment." *Public Opinion Quarterly* (89)4:1138-1153. Replication Package. Preprint..

2025 Seigler, Carolina P.*, **Kristopher Velasco**, and Pamela Paxton."'Choppy Waters': Navigating Political Generational Conflict in Social Movement Organizations." *American Sociological Review* 90(6): 1092-1122.

2025 Hoffmann, Nathan I.,* and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Sexuality, Migration, and LGB Policy: A Portrait of Immigrants in Same-Sex Couples in the United States." *International Migration Review* 59(3): 1500-1529. Replication Package. Preprint.

2025 Budnick, Jamie, Christina Pao*, and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Queer Data for Sociologists of Sexualities: Introducing SOGIESC Measurement & Methods During Political Suppression." *Sex and Sexualities* 1(1).

2024 **Velasco, Kristopher** and Jeffrey Swindle. "Assembling God's 'Last Best Hope': The Expanding Reach of the World Congress of Families." *Mobilization: An International Quarterly* 29(4):441-468. Data. Preprint.

2024 **Velasco, Kristopher**, Siddhartha Baral,* and Yun (Nancy) Tang*. "Is Democracy Bad for LGBT+ Rights?" *Journal of Democracy* 35(3): 131-148.

2024 Hoffmann, Nathan I.,* and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Political Dimensions of Rising Mixed-Citizenship, Same-Sex Couples: A Difference-in-Differences-in-Differences Analysis." *Social Forces* 102(3): 1134-1156. Replication Package. Preprint.

2023 **Velasco, Kristopher**. "Transnational Backlash and the Deinstitutionalization of Liberal Norms: LGBT+ Rights in a Contested World." *American Journal of Sociology* 128(5): 1381 1429. Preprint.

- Best Scholarly Article Award, Human Rights Section, American Sociological Association
- Steven C. Poe Graduate Student Paper Award, Human Rights Section, International Studies Association
- Best Graduate Student Paper, Honorable Mention, Human Rights Section, American Sociological Association

2023 Cole, Wade, Evan Schofer, and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Individual Empowerment, Institutional Confidence, and Vaccination Rates in Cross-National Perspective, 1995 to 2018." *American Sociological Review* 88(3): 379-417.

2023 **Velasco, Kristopher**. "Opposition Avoidance or Mutual Engagement?: The Interdependent Relationship in Where Opposing Transnational LGBT+ Networks Locate." *Social Forces* 101(4): 2087-2116. Preprint.

2022 Lerch, Julia C., Evan Schofer, David John Frank, Wesley Longhofer, Francisco O. Ramirez, Christine Wotipka, and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Women's Participation in the Post-Liberal Era: A Global Perspective." *International Sociology* 37(3): 305-329.

2022 Gonsalves, Tara* and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Seeking Friends in Troubled Times: The Structure and Dynamics of Transnational LGBT Networks in Europe." *Mobilization: An International Quarterly* 27(1): 91-114.

- Best Graduate Student Paper Honorable Mention, Global and Transnational Sociology Section, American Sociological Association

2022 **Velasco, Kristopher** and Pamela Paxton."Deconstructed and Constructive Logics: Explaining Inclusive Language Change in Queer Nonprofits, 1998-2016." *American Journal of Sociology* 127(4): 1267-1310.

2021 Messamore, Andrew*, Pamela Paxton, and **Kristopher Velasco**."Can Government Intervention Increase Volunteers and Donations? Analyzing the Influence of VISTA with a Matched Design." *Administration & Society* 53(10): 1547-1579.

2021 Ressler, Robert W., Pamela Paxton, **Kristopher Velasco**, Lilla Pivnick*, Inbar Weiss*, and Johaness Eichstaedt. "Nonprofits: A Public Policy Tool for the Promotion of Community Subjective Well-Being" *Journal of Public Administration Research & Theory* 31(4): 822-838. Replication Package.

2021 Ressler, Robert W., Pamela Paxton, and **Kristopher Velasco**."Donations in Social Context." *Nonprofit Management & Leadership* 31(4): 693-715.

2021 Paxton, Pamela, **Kristopher Velasco**, and Robert W. Ressler."Does Use of Emotion Increase Donations and Volunteers for Nonprofits?"*American Sociological Review* 85(6): 1051-1083.

- Best Article, Public & Nonprofit Division, Academy of Management

2020 **Velasco, Kristopher**."A Growing Queer Divide: The Divergence between Transnational Advocacy Networks and Foreign Aid in Diffusing LGBT Policies."*International Studies Quarterly* 64(1): 120-132. Preprint.

- Best Graduate Student Paper, LGBT Section, American Society for Public Administration

2019 **Velasco, Kristopher**, Pamela Paxton, Robert W. Ressler*, Inbar Weiss*, and Lilla Pivnick*."Do National Service Programs Improve Subjective Well-Being in Communities?"*American Review of Public Administration* 49(3): 275–291.

2019 Weiss, Inbar*, Pamela Paxton, **Kristopher Velasco**, and Robert W. Ressler*."Revisiting Declines in Social Capital: Evidence from a New Measure" *Social Indicators Research* 142(3): 1015-1029.

2018 **Velasco, Kristopher**."Human Rights INGOs, LGBT INGOs, and LGBT Policy Diffusion, 1991-2015.""*Social Forces* 97(1): 377-404.

- Best Graduate Student Paper, Human Rights Section, American Sociological Association

- Best Graduate Student Paper Honorable Mention, Global and Transnational Sociology Section, American Sociological Association

Manuscripts

Revise & Resubmit

Baral, Siddhartha,* Yun (Nancy) Tang,* and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Born Under Constraint: State Regulation and the Changing Ecology of LGBT+ NGO Foundings." Preprint. *Social Forces.*

Velasco, Kristopher. "Sexual Statecraft: A Theory of Sexuality, Classification, and State Power." *Sociological Theory.*

Velasco, Kristopher. "The Division of Labor in Organizational Fields: How Financial Infrastructure Produces Movement Ecologies." *American Journal of Sociology.*

Velasco, Kristopher. "Who Is the Foreign Interloper? The Sovereigntist Counter-Script in Global LGBTQ+ Contention." *American Journal of Sociology.*

Under Review

Velasco, Kristopher and Su Ertekin-Taner*. "The Logic of Queer Justice: Disaggregating Global Pathways for Recognizing Homosexual Behaviors, Sexual Orientation, and Gender Identity."

Rojas Cabal, Sebastián* and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Money After Marriage: Domestic Liberal Settlement and Reactive Transnationalization."

Baral, Siddhartha, Alessandra Rister Portinari Maranca*, and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Geopolitical Earmarking: Donor Identity and the Moral Politics of LGBTQ+ NGO Funding."

Pao, Christina and **Kristopher Velasco**. "The Gender Distribution: Between- and Within-Country Variation in Gender Expression."

On-Going Projects

Swindle, Jeffrey and **Kristopher Velasco**. "From "Christian" to "Nationalist": How the World Congress of Families Made Anti-Gender Anxieties Central to Contemporary Transnational Illiberalism."

Velasco,Kristopher. "The Democratic Diaspora: Emigrant Destinations and Resilience to Democratic Backsliding."

Book Chapters, Reviews, and Other Publications

Forthcoming **Velasco, Kristopher**. Review of *Marriage Material: How an Enduring Institution is Changing Same-Sex Relationships.* By Abigail Ocobock. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. *American Journal of Sociology.*

2018 Paxton, Pamela and **Kristopher Velasco**. "Gender and Democratization." In *Democratization 2nd Edition* edited by Christian Haerpfer, Patrick Bernhagen, Ronald F. Inglehart, and Christian Welzel. Oxford University Press.

2016 Paxton, Pamela, Inbar Weiss*, Lilla Pivnick*, Robert W. Ressler*, and **Kristopher Velasco**. Final Report: A New County-level Measure of Social Capital. Corporation for National

and Community Service, Office of Research and Evaluation. Washington, D.C.

Datasets

Velasco, Kristopher. "LGBTI Policy Index, 1991-2019"
Velasco, Kristopher. E-Filed Form 990 & Form 990-EZ XMLs. Extraction Code. Data.
Velasco, Kristopher. Paper-Filed Form 990: 2008-2019. Data.
Velasco, Kristopher and Jeffrey Swindle. The World Congress of Families Dataset v1.0.
Velasco, Kristopher and Tara Gonsalves. "The Global LGBTQ+ NGO Database." *In Progress.*

Research Grants

2023-2026 "Organizations in a Post-Liberal World: A Cross-National Investigation into the Changing Scales, Strategies, and Missions of LGBT+ NGOs." National Science Foundation, Science of Organizations. *$292,287.*

2023 "Making the Forms 990 Open Access: Unleashing Nonprofit Tax Data to Invigorate Social Science Research." Princeton University, Data-Driven Social Science Initiative. *$33,400.*

2023 "Mission Impossible: How LGBT+ Organizations Navigate between Global Demands and Local Need in Mission Statements." Princeton University, Dean of Faculty. *$11,100.*

2022 "Progress for Whom?: Analyzing How LGBTQ Legal Victories Influence U.S. Anti-LGBTQ Organizations' Foreign Expenditures." Princeton University, Data-Driven Social Science Initiative. *$3,599.*

2018 "Fall Research Grant." University of Texas at Austin, Department of Sociology. *$1,000.*

Fellowships and Awards

2021 Best Poster Award, Population Association of America
2021 Postdoctoral Scholar, LGBT Policy Lab, Vanderbilt University (*Declined*)
2020 Dissertation Fellowship, Ford Foundation (*$28,000*)
2020 University Graduate Continuing Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin (*$44,000*)
2020 Dean Prestigious Fellowship Supplement, University of Texas at Austin (*$4,000*)
2019 Department Excellence Award, University of Texas at Austin, Sociology (*$5,000*)
2018 Department Excellence Award, University of Texas at Austin, Sociology (*$5,000*)
2017 Pre-Doctoral Research Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, Sociology (*$5,000*)
2016 Pre-Doctoral Research Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, Sociology (*$5,000*)
2015 McNair Diversity Recruitment Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, (*$24,000*)

Presentations and Panels

Invited

2026 "Architectures of Hate: U.S. Civil Society and the Undoing of Global LGBTQ+ Rights"

- Central European University Democracy Institute, Budapest, Hungary, May

2025 "Surviving Repression: Lessons from LGBTQ+ Civil Societies Around the World."

- Bridging the Gap and the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, Washington, D.C., November

2025 "Feminist Research and Data Activism in Political Turmoil."

- FemQuant, Online, November

2025 "The Global Anti-LGBTQ+ Movement."

- Global Philanthropy Project, Philadelphia, April
- Human Dignity Trust, 4th Global Decriminalisation Convening, Thailand, March

2025 "Queering Repression: How the Global Crackdown on Civil Society Affects LGBT+ NGO Foundings."

- Boston University, Global Development Policy Center, February

2024 "The Global Anti-LGBTQ+ Movement."

- Harvard University, Kennedy School, Global LGBTQI+ Human Rights Program, October

2024 "Queering Repression: How the Global Crackdown on Civil Society Affects LGBT+ NGO Foundings."

- University of California, Santa Barbara, Department of Global Studies, May

2024 "Transnational Backlash and the Deinstitutionalization of Liberal Norms: LGBT+ Rights in a Contested World."

- Harvard University, Department of Sociology, April

2024 "Sexuality, Migration, and LGB Policy: A Portrait of Immigrants in Same-Sex Couples in the United States."

- Harvard University, Social Demography Seminar, February

2023 "Queering Repression: How the Global Crackdown on Civil Society Affects LGBT+ NGO Foundings."

- Harvard University, Politics *&* Social Change Workshop, November
- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Department of Sociology, October

2023 "Transnational Backlash and the Deinstitutionalization of Liberal Norms: LGBT+ Rights in a Contested World."

- University of Pennsylvania, Department of Sociology, November
- University of California, Los Angeles, Department of Sociology, November
- Columbia University, Department of Sociology, November

2023 "Progress for Whom?: How LGBT+ Legal Victories at Home Change U.S. 'Pro-Family' Organizations' International Expenditures."

- Columbia University, Science, Knowledge, and Technology Workshop, May
- University of California, Irvine, International Comparative Sociology Workshop, May

2023 "Is the Global LGBTQ+ Rights Movement Stalling? A Discussion with Professor Kristopher Velasco."

- Princeton University, Princeton Pride Alliance, April

2023 "LGBT+ Rights and the Future of Equality: A Global Story in Three Acts."

- American Sociological Association, Global Queer Activism, August
- Eastern Sociological Society, Presidential Panel: Coordinated Global Assaults and Advancements for LGBT+ Communities, February

2023 "LGBTQ+ Research in Sociology: Institutionalization, Intellectual Contributions, and Impediments."

- University of Oxford, Nuffield College, LGBTQI+ History Month Panel, February

2022 "LGBT+ Rights and the Future of Equality: A Global Story in Three Acts."

- Princeton University, Global Existential Challenges Seminar Series, December

2022 "The Rise of Transnational, Anti-Gender/LGBT+ Networks."

- Harvard University, Gender *&* Development Seminar, November

2022 "Transnational Backlash and the Deinstitutionalization of Liberal Norms: LGBT+ Rights in a Contested World."

- Stanford University, SCANCOR, November
- University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee, Department of Sociology, September
- Occidental College, March

2022 "The Logics of Queer Justice: Disaggregating Pathways for Advancing Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity-Based Rights."

- Princeton University, Law@Princeton Retreat, May

2022 "LGBTQ Scholars and Experiences in Sociology."

- Princeton University, Department of Sociology, April

2022 "Deconstructed and Constructive Logics: Explaining Inclusive Language Change in Queer Nonprofits, 1998-2016."

- Princeton University, Social Science Seminar, Department of Psychology, February

2021 "LGBTQ Scholars and Scholarship in the Academy."

- Princeton University, Queer Politics Webinar, April

2020 "Queering the World Society: Global Norms, Rival Transnational Networks, and the Case of LGBT Rights."

- Princeton University, Queer Politics Webinar, July

2019 "Caught in a Web: The Role of Transnational Networks in (Un)Doing LGBTI Rights."

- University of Notre Dame, Younger Scholars in the Sociology of Religion, April

2018 "Norm Translation and Political Backlash: How Countering Transnational Networks Shape Queer Visibility." with Tara Gonsalves.

- University of Pittsburgh, Transnational Networks and Social Change Workshop, September

Conference

2026 American Sociological Association; Population Association of America
2025 International Studies Association; Population Association of America; American Sociological Association
2024 International Studies Association; American Political Science Association; American Sociological Association
2023 Eastern Sociological Society; International Studies Association; Mobilization Conference; American Political Science Association; American Sociological Association
2022 American Sociological Association; Western Political Science Association; "Weaving the Transnational Anti-Gender Network Conference" (*Scuola Normale Superiore, Florence, Italy*)
2021 American Sociological Association; International Studies Association; Population Association of America (*Awarded Best Poster Award with Nathan I. Hoffmann*)
2020 American Sociological Association; International Studies Association
2019 American Sociological Association; Association for Research on Nonprofit and Voluntary Action; Corporation for National and Community Service Research Summit; "Development in Dialogue Conference" (*University of Notre Dame*); "Future of the World Society Mini-Conference" (*Columbia University*)
2018 American Sociological Association; Association for Research on Nonprofit and Voluntary Action; Corporation for National and Community Service Research Summit; Society for the Study of Social Problems; International Sociological Association
2017 American Sociological Association
2016 Association for Research on Nonprofit and Voluntary Action; Corporation for National and Community Service Research Summit; World Society Mini-Conference (*University of Washington*)

Public Writing and Media Interviews

2025 "The Trump Administration Is Promoting Its Anti-Trans Agenda Globally at the United Nations". *ProPublica.*
2024 "Ghana law tests World Bank loyalty with $20 billion on the line". *Bloomberg News.*
2024 "How could the U.S. election affect LGBTQ+ aid funding?" *Context.*

Teaching and Advising

Undergraduate Teaching

Spring 2026 "Sexuality in Global Contexts." Princeton University" Princeton University
Spring 2025 "Sexuality in Global Contexts." Princeton University" Princeton University
Fall 2024 "Statistical Methods in Sociology." Princeton University
Spring 2023 "Identities: Race, Class, Gender, & Sexuality." Princeton University
Fall 2022 "Sexuality in Global Contexts." Princeton University
Spring 2022 "Identities: Race, Class, Gender, & Sexuality." Princeton University
Fall 2021 "Sexuality in Global Contexts." Princeton University
Su' 2019 "Introduction to Statistics and Statistical Computing." University of Texas at Austin

Undergraduate Advising

Senior Thesis	Nathan Zelizer ('26-'27); Andrew Jung ('24-'25: Winner of the Willard Thorp Thesis Prize, Effron Center for the Study of America, Princeton University, Winner of the Isidore Brown Thesis Prize, Department of Sociology, Princeton University); Isaac Bledsoe ('22-'23); Naomi Frim-Abrams ('22-'23); Simran Khanna ('21-'22); Isabelle Nimick ('21-'22); Jeremiah Tyler ('21-'22)
Junior Paper	Radon Belarmino ('25); Chad Palumbo ('25); McKenzie Blake ('24); Elizabeth Agatucci ('23); Kutorkor Kotey ('23); Eliana Gagnon ('22); Kai Obinata ('22)

Graduate Teaching

Spring 2023	"Techniques and Methods of Social Science." Princeton University

Graduate Advising

Current	Christina Pao (Princeton University, Sociology, Dissertation Co-Chair) Sebastián Rojas Cabal (Princeton University, Sociology, Dissertation Committee Member) Yun (Nancy) Tang (Princeton University, Politics, Dissertation Committee Member) Margaret Palmer (University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Sociology, Dissertation Committee Member)
2025	Alejandro Garcia Fernandez (Princeton University, Sociology, Dissertation External Reader)
2024	María José Urzúa Valverde (Princeton University, Politics, Dissertation Committee Member)
2022	John Maldonado (Princeton University, Sociology, Dissertation External Reader)

Academic Service

Academic Journals

On-Going Reviewer	*Administration & Society (x1), African Affairs (x1), American Journal of Political Science (x3), American Journal of Sociology (x11), American Sociological Review (x10), Contemporary Sociology (x1), Demographic Research (x1), European Journal of Politics and Gender (x2), European Journal of Sociology (x1), European Political Science Review (x1), European Politics & Society (x1), European Societies (x2), European Sociological Review (x1), Foreign Policy Analysis (x1), Gender & Society (x2), Global Society (x1), Global Studies Quarterly (x2), International Journal of Discrimination and the Law (x1), International Journal of Public Opinion Research (x3), International Organization (x2), International Political Sociology (x1), Journal of Baltic Studies (x2), Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis (x1), Journal of Development Studies (x1), Journal of Environmental Psychology (x2), Journal of Health and Social Behavior (x3), Journal of Homosexuality (x2), Journal of Politics (x2), Journal of Refugee Studies (x1), Law & Social Inquiry (x1), Mobilization: An International Quarterly (x5), Nonprofit & Voluntary Sector Quarterly (x2), Nonprofit Management & Leadership (x4), Nonprofit Policy Forum (x1), Policy Studies (x1), Political Studies Review (x1), Politics & Gender (x3), Politics, Groups, & Identities (x1), Population, Space & Place (x1), Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (x1), Religions (x1), Review of International Studies (x2), Sexuality & Culture (x1), Sexuality Research & Social Policy (x2), Social Current (x1), Social Forces (x20), Social Movement Studies (x1), Social Problems (x2), Social Science Research (x1),*

Sociological Forum (x1), Sociological Methodology (x1), Sociological Methods & Research (x1), Sociological Perspectives (x2), Sociology of Development (x3), The Sociological Quarterly (x6), Third World Quarterly (x1)

2024- Editorial Board Member, *The Sociological Quarterly*
2023- Editorial Board Member, *Social Forces*
2024-2026 Editorial Board Member, *European Journal of Politics and Gender*
2024-2026 Associate Editor, *Sex and Sexualities*
2021-2025 Editorial Board Member, *Sociology of Development*

Granting Institutions

On-Going Reviewer National Science Foundation

Associations

2019- American Sociological Association

- Elected Chair of Sexualities Section, 2025-2028
- Elected Council Member of Human Rights Section, 2025-2028
- Distinguished Contribution to Scholarship for an Award Committee, Political Sociology Section, 2025
- Clifford Geertz Best Article Award Committee, Culture Section, 2025
- Organizer, Regular Session on Transnational Processes, Annual Meeting, 2024
- Best Graduate Student Paper Award Committee, Sexualities Section, 2024
- Organizer, Special Session: Global Queer Activism, Annual Meeting, 2023
- Organizer, Regular Session on Voluntary and Nonprofit Organizations, Annual Meeting, 2022
- Best Graduate Student Paper Award Committee, Sexualities Section, 2022
- Richard A. Peterson Award for Best Student Paper Committee, Culture Section, 2022
- Organizer, Roundtables, Global & Transnational Sociology Section, 2021
- Presider, Roundtables, Global & Transnational Sociology Section, 2019

2021-22 International Studies Association

- Mentor, LGBTQ Caucus Mentoring Program, 2021-2022
- Best Graduate Student Paper Award Committee, Human Rights Section, 2021

2019-20 Association for Research on Nonprofit and Voluntary Associations

- Co-Coordinator, LGBTQIA Common Interest Group, 2019-2020
- Member, Diversity Committee, 2020

Universities

2021- Princeton University

- Co-Organizer, Queer Migrations: How Global Movement Shapes Gender & Sexuality, April 2026
- Faculty Lecturer, Every Voice Conference: Honoring and Celebrating Princeton's LGBTQ+ Alumni, September 2024
- Panelist, Undergraduate Summer Research Colloquium, June 2024
- Organizer, Queer Demography Summit, Office of Population Research, March 2024
- Undergraduate Admission and Financial Aid Committee, 2024-2026
- Faculty Fellow, Scholars Institute Fellows Program, 2021-
- Graduate Admissions Committee, Department of Sociology, 2021-2022

2019-2020 University of Texas at Austin

- Chair, Graduate Student Council, Department of Sociology, 2019-2020

Community

2023-2026 CLAGS: The Center for LGBTQ Studies at Graduate Center, CUNY

- Member, Board of Directors